

1. The Three Major Components of a Computer System

Answer the following questions *in English*. Try and write the exact words you found in the article:

1. What are the three major components of a computer system?

Hardware, software, humanware

2. How does the article define / describe the *first* of these three components?

Can be touched by the human hand.

3. According to the article, what is the most important piece of this first component?

Microprocessor chip == CPU

4. What does the article say about the so-called *graphics processing chip (GPU)*?

New laptop => GPU+CPU == APU

5. The article then goes on to describe another component that is just as important. What is it and how is it described?

Disk drive => where data is stored

6. The article says this component comes in two types. What are they and how are they described?

Hard disk (HDD) => mechanical, data store on magnetic and metallic platters, more fragile

Solid state disk (SSD) => data store on flash memory, faster and more robust

7. The article mentions another component that is vital within a system. What is it and how is it described?

The motherboard => makes the link and the connectivity between all the devices of the computer

8. According to the article, connectivity to that component can be of two types. What are they? Provide three examples of each.

Internal (microprocessor, disk drive, RAM) and external (Monitor, printer, keyboard)

9. How does the article define / describe the *second* of these three components?

All of the instructions, programs, data and protocols that rules the hardware and make it works

10. Regarding that second component, the article distinguishes four different types. What are they and how are they defined/described?

Software can be divided into (1) System software, (2) Application software, (3) Malicious software and (4) Programming software categories.

The article defines / describes them as follows:

1. Manage other software and devices inside the computer => OS (operating system)
2. Designed for end-users to do a specific task, to output useful information
3. Malware => designed by criminals to maim normal operation of a computer
4. Tools used by developers to create all types of software